


Faculty of Civil Engineering · CE5242 Transportation Field School

# Stuttgart 21

## as a Model for Moncton, New Brunswick

*Can transit-led urban redevelopment*
*be adapted to a mid-size Canadian city?*

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# Table of Contents

Table of Contents ..... 2
1. Introduction ..... 3
2. Background ..... 4
2.1 The Stuttgart 21 project ..... 4
2.2 The Rosenstein Quarter redevelopment ..... 4
2.3 Land value capture: theoretical framework ..... 4
2.4 Moncton: existing conditions and planning context ..... 5
3. Methodology ..... 6
3.1 Document review ..... 6
3.2 Field study in Stuttgart ..... 6
3.3 Comparison framework ..... 6
4. Field Observations ..... 7
4.1 Observation 1 — The locked rail yards ..... 7
4.2 Observation 2 — The financing signboards ..... 8
4.3 Observation 3 — Active redevelopment ..... 9
4.4 Observation 4 — The construction boundary ..... 10
4.5 Observation 5 — Sequential land release ..... 11
4.6 Observation 6 — Munich Olympic Village ..... 12
4.7 Observation 7 — Mercedes-Benz Museum bike parking ..... 14
4.8 Observation 8 — Lake Constance multimodal integration ..... 15
5. Analysis ..... 16
5.1 Mechanism transferability and scale adjustment ..... 16
5.2 BRT corridor selection: Vaughan Harvey versus Main Street ..... 16
5.3 Parking redistribution ..... 17
5.4 Financing: Tax Increment Financing gap and alternative mechanism ..... 18
6. Discussion and Conclusions ..... 19
6.1 Model transferability with appropriate adaptation ..... 19
6.2 Alignment with existing Moncton planning policy ..... 19
6.3 Uncertainties and prerequisite work ..... 19
6.4 Conclusions ..... 19
References ..... 21

# 1. Introduction

Mid-size cities across North America face a common infrastructure challenge: how to support population growth with adequate transit, walkable downtowns, and affordable housing without expanding private property tax burdens. Conventional municipal revenue streams typically cannot fund major transit infrastructure on their own, and federal capital grants are inconsistent across funding cycles.

The City of Stuttgart, Germany has pursued an alternative financing approach for the past two decades. The Stuttgart 21 project involves construction of a new underground railway station that, once operational, will free approximately 85 hectares of central rail yard land for redevelopment (Stadt Stuttgart, 2025). This land is currently being converted to mixed-use districts with capacity for approximately 10,000 residents. Proceeds from land sales are contributing to project capital costs. This approach is referred to as transit-led land value capture and forms the central subject of this report.

This report examines whether the same approach could be adapted to Moncton, New Brunswick at an appropriately reduced scale. The City of Moncton presents two land use conditions that parallel Stuttgart's pre-project situation. Approximately 40 percent of the downtown core is occupied by surface parking that generates minimal property tax revenue (City of Moncton, 2018). A 1,400-acre area known as the Vision Lands sits at the city's northern edge and remains undeveloped due to inadequate transit access. These two conditions are linked: a Bus Rapid Transit (BRT) corridor connecting downtown and the Vision Lands could trigger redevelopment in both areas simultaneously.

The analysis presented here is based on a field study conducted in Stuttgart in April 2026, combined with a review of Moncton planning documents and comparable transit-led redevelopment projects in other jurisdictions.

# 2. Background

## 2.1 The Stuttgart 21 project

Stuttgart 21 is a major rail infrastructure project in the German state of Baden-Württemberg. The project converts Stuttgart's main railway station from a 16-platform terminus on the surface to an 8-platform underground through-station, allowing trains to pass straight through rather than reversing. The full project also includes 57 kilometres of new and upgraded rail line and approximately 30 kilometres of associated tunnels. Total project cost is estimated at approximately €9.8 billion, with full operation expected by 2026 or 2027 (Norkauer, 2023).

Above ground, the project's most significant outcome is the release of approximately 85 hectares of central city land currently occupied by surface rail infrastructure. Once the new underground station opens and surface tracks are removed, this land becomes available for redevelopment. The City of Stuttgart has designated this development area as Stuttgart Rosenstein, which represents the largest urban development project in the city's history (Stadt Stuttgart, 2025).

## 2.2 The Rosenstein Quarter redevelopment

The Stuttgart City Council adopted the master plan for Rosenstein in October 2023. The plan provides for between 4,700 and 5,700 new apartments to house approximately 10,000 residents. Three new districts are defined: Europaquartier near the main station, Rosensteinquartier in the centre, and Maker City at the edge near the existing Wagenhallen cultural area (rosenstein-stuttgart.de, 2025).

Several aspects of the master plan are particularly relevant to this analysis. First, a minimum of 50 percent of all housing must be subsidised. This requirement is established by Stuttgart's Interior Development Model, which applies to any development on city-owned land (Stadt Stuttgart, 2023). Second, the plan adds 20 hectares of new public park space, including a curved linear park (the Gleisbogenpark) that traces the former rail alignment and connects the new districts to the existing Schlossgarten. Third, the plan incorporates dedicated provisions for sustainable mobility, including car-sharing infrastructure, cargo-bike sharing facilities, and reduced parking ratios for new residential buildings.

Implementation is proceeding in phases. The first development plan adopted was for the Maker City area near the Wagenhallen. The development plan for the Europaquartier was submitted to City Council in July 2025. A citizens' petition to block the Europaquartier plan was initiated in late 2025 but failed to reach the required threshold of 20,000 signatures, and the Council formally confirmed the plan in December 2025 (rosenstein-stuttgart.de, 2025).

## 2.3 Land value capture: theoretical framework

Land value capture is a financing mechanism in which a portion of the increase in land value produced by public infrastructure investment is recovered to help fund that investment. The concept is well-established in transportation economics. Cervero and Kockelman (1997) demonstrated that transit investment produces

measurable increases in nearby property values. Medda (2012) provides a comprehensive review of the policy instruments through which municipalities can capture these increases.

Several instruments exist within this category. The most common in North America is Tax Increment Financing (TIF). Under a TIF arrangement, a municipality designates a development zone, establishes a baseline property tax assessment, and dedicates the future incremental tax revenue (above the baseline) to repay bonds that finance the original infrastructure investment. Stuttgart 21 employs a more direct mechanism: Deutsche Bahn and the City of Stuttgart hold title to the rail land, and direct sales of freed parcels to developers contribute to project cost recovery.

## 2.4 Moncton: existing conditions and planning context

Moncton is the largest city in New Brunswick and is currently experiencing significant population growth. The downtown core exhibits a land-use pattern characteristic of mid-size North American cities, with approximately 40 percent of downtown land area occupied by surface parking lots that generate minimal property tax revenue per unit area (City of Moncton, 2018).

Moncton's regional transportation master plan, Destination 2040, was adopted in 2015 (HDR, 2015). The plan identified seven strategic priorities, one of which — Priority G — explicitly calls for intensification of land use through density and transit-oriented development along key corridors. The plan further recommended implementation of parking management strategies and pricing as a short-term action for the 2016 to 2020 period. Over a decade later, these recommendations have not been substantially implemented. The plan also reported that 83 percent of trips in 2013 were made as auto driver, with a target of reducing this to 73 percent by 2041 — a modest shift over a 25-year horizon.

The Codiac Transpo Growth Strategy, published in January 2026, addresses transit signal priority improvements and service frequency enhancements. A statement from the transit planner involved in the strategy provided directly relevant context regarding the feasibility of dedicated bus infrastructure: dedicated bus lanes "can be expensive, and not every city has the right of way or the road width to be able to support something like that" (CBC News, 2026). This statement is significant because it indicates that full BRT implementation on Main Street is not considered realistic by the city's own transit planning function.

The Vision Lands comprise 1,400 acres at Moncton's northern edge. The current master plan envisions approximately 14,000 housing units accommodating 30,000 residents. The Urban Growth Strategy (City of Moncton, 2024) identifies infrastructure cost as the primary barrier to developing these lands — the specific condition that land value capture mechanisms are designed to address.

# 3. Methodology

The analysis presented in this report draws on three methodological components: a literature and document review, a field study in Germany, and a structured cross-jurisdictional comparison.

## 3.1 Document review

The initial phase consisted of reviewing the relevant academic literature on land value capture and transit-oriented development, with primary reliance on Cervero and Kockelman (1997) and Medda (2012). Documentation of the Stuttgart 21 project was drawn from Norkauer (2023) and the City of Stuttgart's Rosenstein development website. Documentation of the Moncton planning context was drawn from Destination 2040 (HDR, 2015), the Codiac Transpo Growth Strategy (Codiac Transpo, 2026), the Urban Growth Strategy (City of Moncton, 2024), and the Downtown Community Improvement Plan (City of Moncton, 2018).

A notable limitation of the document review is the age of Destination 2040. The plan was finalised in 2015 when Moncton's population was approximately 70,000 and before the Vision Lands planning process had reached its current stage. While the plan's strategic priorities remain relevant, more recent documents are treated as the primary source of current municipal policy direction.

## 3.2 Field study in Stuttgart

The field study was conducted in Stuttgart and surrounding areas during April 2026 as part of the CE5242 Transportation Field School. Five observation themes were established in advance, each linked to a specific element of the proposed Moncton adaptation:

- The surface rail yards — representing the locked central land asset
- The official project signboards — documenting the multi-party financing structure
- The active redevelopment sites — demonstrating implementation in practice
- The construction boundary along city streets — illustrating community impact
- The northern rail corridor — illustrating sequential phased land release

The Moncton context was assessed through document review only, without parallel field observation. This represents a methodological limitation acknowledged in Section 6.

## 3.3 Comparison framework

The cross-jurisdictional comparison is structured around six dimensions: the nature of the locked land asset, the proposed transit intervention, the primary land unlocked by that intervention, the financing mechanism, the project scale, and the political conditions for implementation. The framework draws on Medda (2012) and is used to identify where the Stuttgart model transfers directly and where it requires adaptation to the Moncton context.

# 4. Field Observations

The following observations were recorded during the field study in April 2026. Observations 4.1 through 4.5 cover the Stuttgart 21 project site, which was the primary focus of the study. Observations 4.6 through 4.8 were collected during excursions to other locations on the field school itinerary — Munich, the Mercedes-Benz Museum in Stuttgart, and the Lake Constance region. These excursions provided supplementary observations on related transit and urban-mobility principles applicable to the Moncton context. Each observation in this section is linked to one element of the proposed Moncton adaptation. All photographs were taken on site during the study.

## 4.1 Observation 1 — The locked rail yards



*Figure 1: Stuttgart's surface rail marshalling yards — the locked central land that the project will free (April 2026)*

The photograph above was taken from an elevated walkway near the Rosenstein Quarter and shows the full extent of Stuttgart's surface rail yards. Multiple sidings hold dozens of passenger and freight rail cars. The tracks, overhead catenary infrastructure, signalling equipment, and maintenance buildings together occupy land that, despite being within walking distance of the city centre, generates substantially less economic value per hectare than the surrounding urban fabric.

This represents a direct visual parallel to Moncton's downtown parking condition. Both situations share the same basic characteristic: high-footprint, low-intensity land use occupying some of the most accessible land

in the city. In Stuttgart, relocation of rail operations underground converts this land from a financial liability into the primary asset funding the broader project. The analogous intervention in Moncton — conversion of downtown surface parking lots into mixed-use buildings — applies the same logic at a reduced scale. In both cases, the land itself functions as the financing mechanism; the precondition is that it must first be unlocked.

## 4.2 Observation 2 — The financing signboards

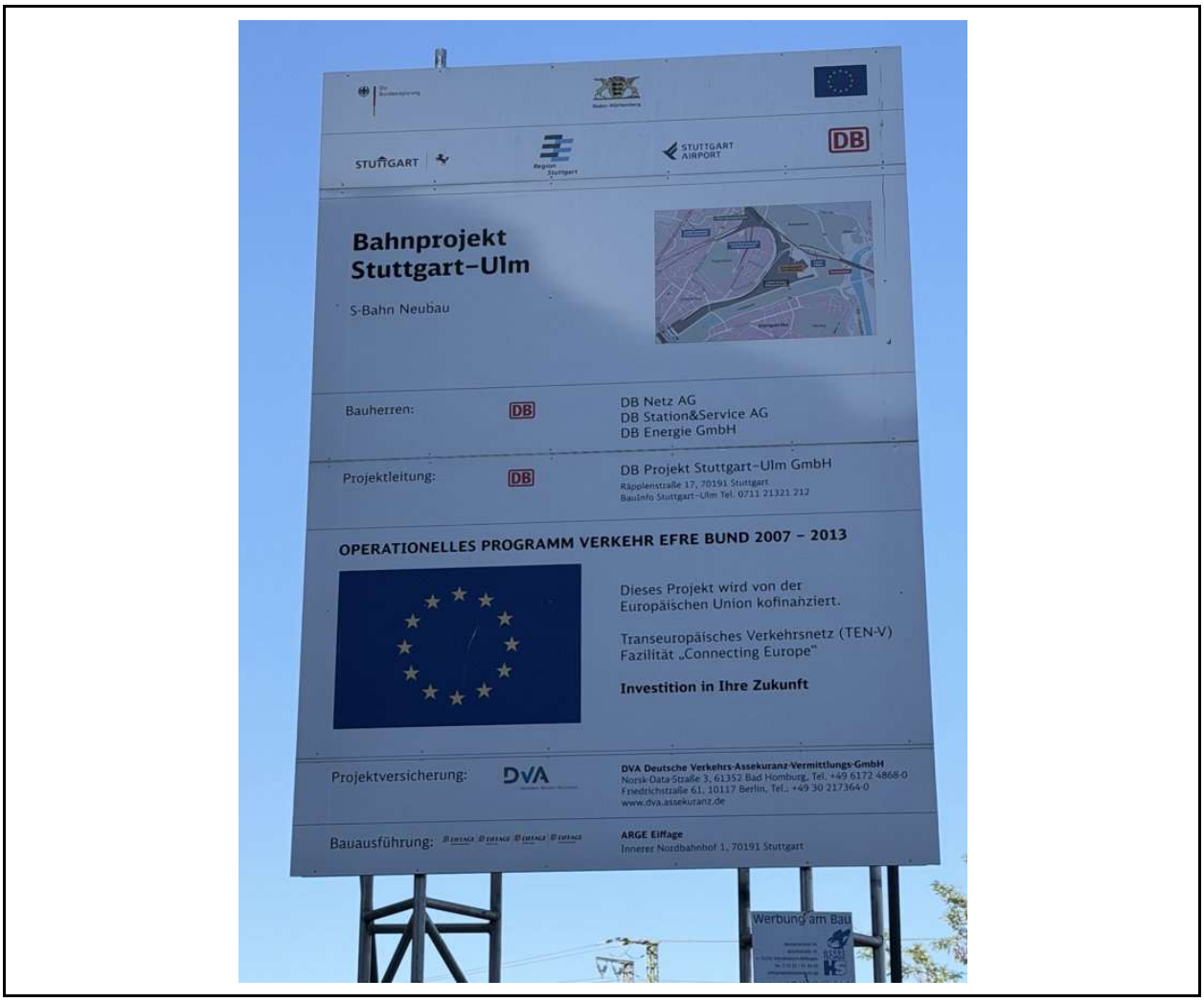



*Figure 2: Project signboard listing all funding partners — federal, state, EU TEN-V "Connecting Europe" facility, Deutsche Bahn (April 2026)*

The photograph above shows the official project signboard for the S-Bahn Neubau (new construction) section near the Nordbahnhof. The project owners (Bauherren) are three Deutsche Bahn subsidiaries: DB Netz AG, DB Station & Service AG, and DB Energie GmbH. The signboard explicitly identifies the project as co-financed by the European Union through the TEN-V "Connecting Europe" Facility, and references the Operationelles Programm Verkehr EFRE Bund 2007-2013. This indicates that EU funding commitment was secured more than a decade before construction in this phase commenced.

Six funding partners are listed across the top of the signboards observed on site: the federal government, the State of Baden-Württemberg, the City of Stuttgart, Region Stuttgart, Stuttgart Airport, and Deutsche Bahn.

This funding structure is directly relevant to the Moncton context. Stuttgart 21 was not financed by a single level of government, nor by private capital alone. The project required sustained co-investment from municipal, state, federal, and supranational sources coordinated over several decades. A Moncton BRT project would correspondingly require federal funding through Build Canada, provincial capital allocation, and a municipal contribution through city-owned land sales. The Stuttgart signboards confirm that this layered funding structure is established practice for transit projects of comparable type.

## 4.3 Observation 3 — Active redevelopment




*Figure 3: Active construction on former rail yard land, Rosenstein area, with the Godel-Beton concrete plant supplying the tunnel works (April 2026)*

The photograph above documents the active redevelopment phase on land previously occupied by surface rail infrastructure. Cement mixer trucks from the Godel-Beton concrete plant are visible alongside excavation equipment, earth stockpiles, and staging areas for precast concrete elements. The Godel-Beton concrete plant tower in the background indicates the volume of concrete required for the underground station and tunnels.

This observation provides physical evidence that the Stuttgart land value capture mechanism is operational rather than theoretical. Freed land is not being held in reserve — it is actively under construction, producing the mixed-use districts that will subsequently generate property tax revenue and contribute to project cost recovery. In the Moncton context, the Avenir Centre, built on former CN rail land in downtown Moncton, already demonstrates this principle at a smaller scale. The Stuttgart project illustrates what a coordinated, city-scale application of the same approach produces over time.

## 4.4 Observation 4 — The construction boundary



*Figure 4: Construction hoarding along a Stuttgart city street with project graphics depicting the future underground station's chalice-shaped light apertures (April 2026)*

The photograph above documents the street-level interface between the construction site and the surrounding urban area. The construction hoarding extends for several hundred metres along the adjacent roadway, wrapped in large-format graphics depicting the future underground station's distinctive architecture, including the chalice-shaped roof openings that will admit natural light to the underground concourse. A red panel invites public engagement with the construction process. Normal vehicular traffic continues alongside the hoarding throughout the construction period.

This observation highlights an issue that is rarely addressed in transit planning literature: the disruption costs borne by adjacent property owners and businesses during construction. Stuttgart's approach — using high-quality project graphics and public engagement signage along the construction boundary — functions as a deliberate strategy for maintaining community support over the extended construction period. Any Moncton BRT corridor implementation involving road reconfiguration on Vaughan Harvey Boulevard would create comparable disruption to adjacent businesses. The Stuttgart precedent indicates that the visual quality of the construction boundary is not merely cosmetic; it functions as a tool for maintaining political sustainability across a multi-year project timeline.

## 4.5 Observation 5 — Sequential land release



*Figure 5: Cleared land along Nordbahnhofstraße at the northern construction zone, with precast concrete tunnel segments staged for installation (April 2026)*

The photograph above, taken near the Nordbahnhof construction zone, documents one stage in the sequential land release process. Precast concrete tunnel segments are stacked along the cleared edge of the site, awaiting installation in the underground bore. The embankment in the background shows existing rail lines that remain operational at surface level while tunnelling continues below. A municipal parking sign is visible at the right edge of the frame, indicating an existing surface parking area that will be displaced progressively as the Rosenstein Quarter develops northward.

This observation illustrates a critical sequencing principle that the proposed Moncton adaptation must incorporate. Stuttgart 21 does not release all 85 hectares of rail land at a single point. Land is released progressively as underground works advance and surface operations are transferred. The northern corridor depicted in the photograph is in an intermediate state — partial release while construction continues. In the Moncton context, this principle implies that the BRT corridor construction and the downtown parking lot redevelopment programme should proceed in parallel rather than sequentially. BRT construction on Vaughan

Harvey Boulevard would proceed alongside the sale of downtown parking lots, with revenue from each phase contributing to financing the next. The self-financing logic Stuttgart demonstrates over a 30-year horizon would need to be compressed into Moncton's projected 20- to 25-year Vision Lands build-out period.

## 4.6 Observation 6 — Munich Olympic Village



*Figure 6: Munich Olympic Park, with the Olympiaturm and Olympic stadium roof visible behind the bungalow rooftops (April 2026)*

The photograph above shows the Munich Olympic Park as observed during the field study. The Olympiaturm television tower is visible at upper left, and the tent-roof structures of the Olympic stadium can be seen across the central park. The foreground shows the rooftops of the Olympic Village residential bungalows. Bicycle parking is visible in the lower-left plaza, indicating active resident use of the site fifty years after its original construction.

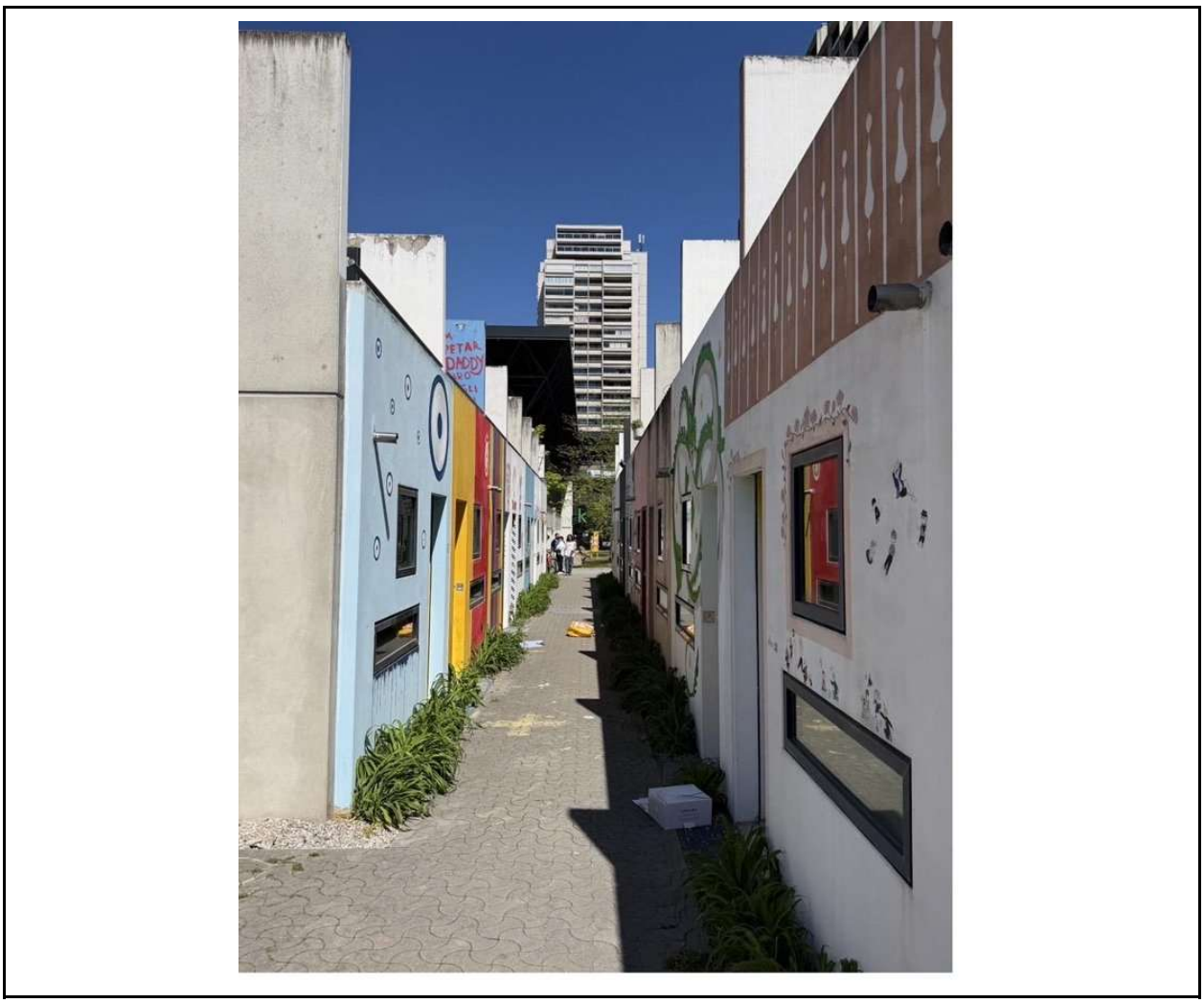


*Figure 7: A pedestrianised lane between student bungalows in the Olympic Village — painted by residents, completely car-free (April 2026)*

This photograph captures the interior pedestrian network of the Olympic Village. The narrow lanes between the original 1972 student bungalows are exclusively pedestrian. Vehicle access is provided at an underground level that is not visible from the residential plaza. The exterior walls of the bungalows have been progressively painted by residents over five decades, producing the distinctive visual character of the area.

The relevant principle for Moncton is that comprehensive transit and land use transformation does not necessarily require an incremental approach. In preparation for the 1972 Olympic Games, Munich constructed its first two U-Bahn lines, completed the regional S-Bahn network, and pedestrianised the central city, all within a six-year window (Olympics.com, 2022). The Olympic Village itself was designed as a car-free residential area, with all parking and vehicular circulation routed underground and exclusively pedestrian space at the surface level (Olympics.com, 2026). The Village currently accommodates approximately 8,000 residents, predominantly students, families, and seniors. A single major catalyst project, such as the Vision Lands development, could similarly drive generational change in Moncton if supported by sustained political commitment.

## 4.7 Observation 7 — Mercedes-Benz Museum bike parking



*Figure 8: Two-level covered bike parking under the elevated road next to the Mercedes-Benz Museum, Stuttgart (April 2026)*

The photograph above shows a two-level covered bicycle parking facility constructed in the space beneath an overpass adjacent to the Mercedes-Benz Museum entrance. A perimeter mesh fence provides security without significantly reducing visual transparency. The facility appears to be in active use, with bicycles visible on both levels.

This observation demonstrates that high-quality cycling infrastructure does not necessarily require significant capital investment. The space beneath the overpass would otherwise have remained unutilised. The addition of bicycle racks, a fence, and basic lighting converted residual structural space into sheltered, free, and accessible bicycle storage. The principle is directly transferable to the Moncton context, which has substantial residual space under existing bridges and overpasses suitable for similar treatment. Such interventions can be implemented at very low cost relative to other transportation infrastructure investments.

## 4.8 Observation 8 — Lake Constance multimodal integration



*Figure 9: Konrad bikes available near the Germany-Switzerland border*

Lake Constance (Bodensee) was visited during the field study as an example of regional multimodal transport integration. The 273-kilometre Bodensee-Radweg cycle path circumnavigates the lake across three countries — Germany, Austria, and Switzerland. Riders can transfer between train, ferry, and bicycle modes using a single multimodal ticket, the Bodensee Ticket (bodensee-ticket.com, 2025). The City of Konstanz also operates a public bike-share programme called konrad, consisting of 150 standard bicycles and 70 cargo bicycles available 24 hours a day (Konstanz Stadtwerke, 2025).

The applicable principle for Moncton is that active transportation infrastructure — cycling networks, bike-share systems, and rental programmes — should be integrated directly into the transit fare structure and trip-planning interface, rather than being administered as a separate recreational programme. A coordinated multimodal ticket, even in a much smaller transit system, lowers the friction of mode-shifting and increases overall ridership.

# 5. Analysis

## 5.1 Mechanism transferability and scale adjustment

Stuttgart 21 represents an investment of approximately €9.8 billion serving a metropolitan area of 2.8 million people. A direct replication of this scale in Moncton, which has a population of approximately 100,000, would be infeasible. The appropriate scale for Moncton is not an underground rail project but a Bus Rapid Transit (BRT) corridor, with an estimated capital cost between $100 and $200 million.

The underlying mechanism, however, is the same in both jurisdictions. Transit infrastructure is constructed; the construction unlocks land made more valuable by that transit; land is sold or developed; and the proceeds contribute to project financing. The mechanism is scale-independent. What matters is whether locked land exists near a planned transit corridor, and whether municipal and regional institutions can sequence the constituent steps appropriately.

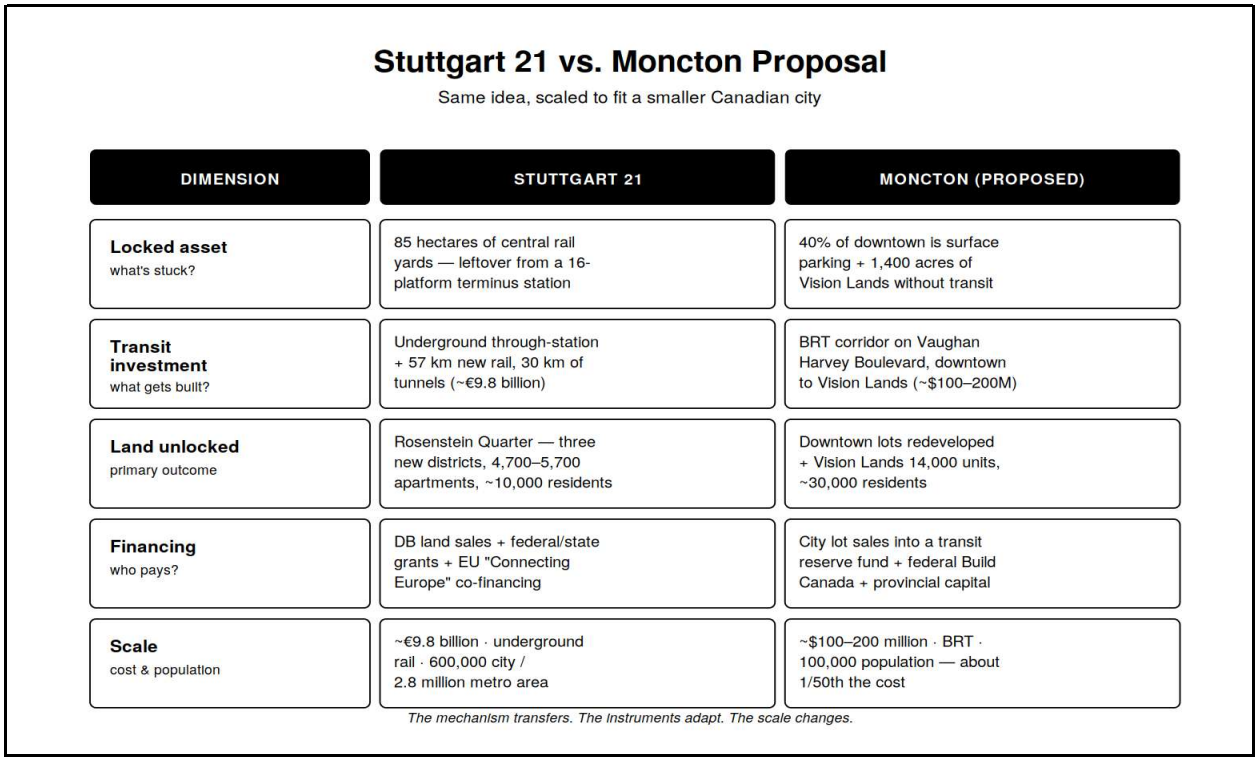



*Figure 10: Side-by-side comparison of Stuttgart 21 and the proposed Moncton adaptation across five dimensions (Generated using AI-based diagramming tools)*

## 5.2 BRT corridor selection: Vaughan Harvey versus Main Street

Main Street in downtown Moncton is not a viable candidate for a dedicated BRT lane. The corridor carries 15,000 to 25,000 vehicles per day, is provincially designated (any major modification requires provincial approval), and extends only 1.6 kilometres through the downtown area. The Codiac Growth Strategy planner's statement regarding right-of-way limitations applies directly to this corridor.

Vaughan Harvey Boulevard presents a substantially different profile. It is a four-lane arterial with a central median and no on-street parking. Separated cycle lanes were added in 2023, demonstrating that lane reallocation on this corridor is both technically and politically feasible. The corridor also runs from the downtown core north toward the Vision Lands area, aligning with the proposed transit-to-redevelopment connection. The recommended corridor is therefore not Main Street with a dedicated lane, but Vaughan Harvey Boulevard with a dedicated lane, supplemented by transit signal priority on the existing downtown street network.

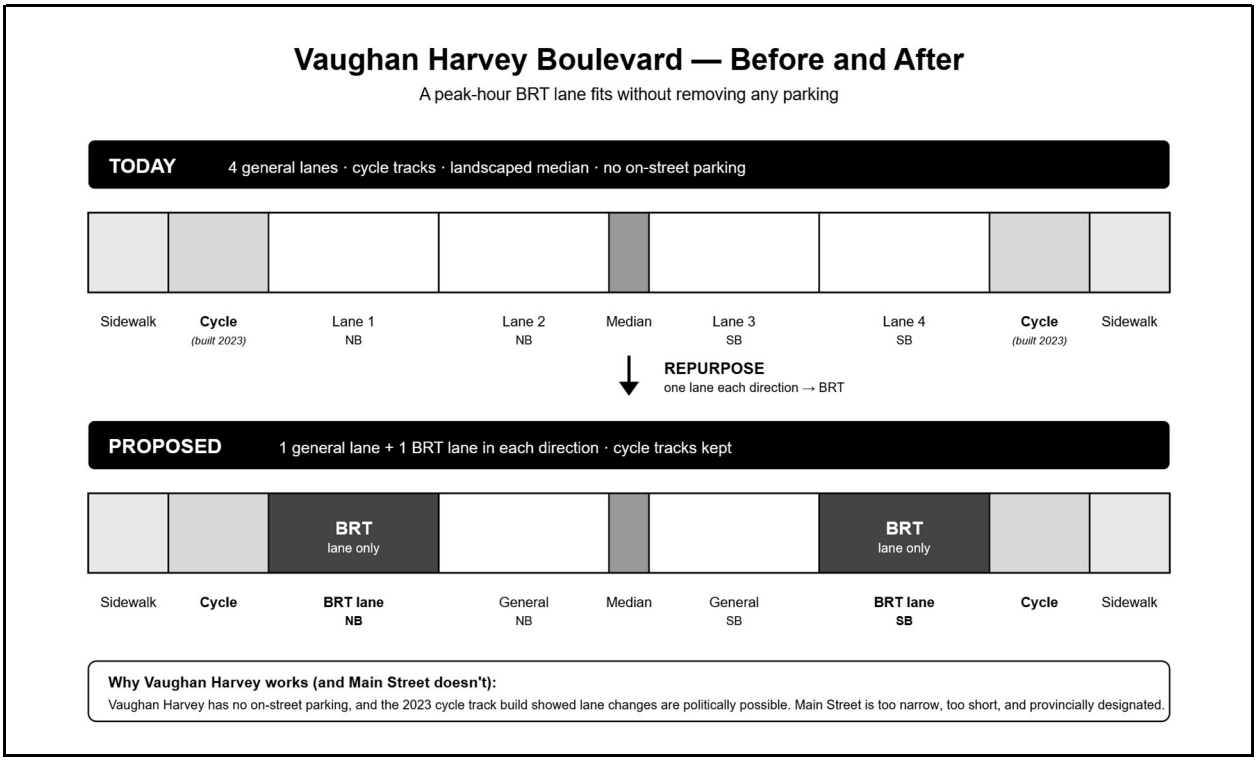



*Figure 11: Vaughan Harvey Boulevard cross-section, before and after — a peak-hour BRT lane fits without removing parking or cycle tracks (Generated using AI-based diagramming tools)*

## 5.3 Parking redistribution

Stuttgart did not eliminate private vehicle use; it redistributed it. Vehicles continue to operate in central Stuttgart, but face high parking rates downtown and inexpensive or free Park-and-Ride facilities at S-Bahn stops on the city's edge. The differential pricing produces the behavioural change. Most commuters elect to park at peripheral facilities and complete their journey by rail.

Moncton can adopt an analogous three-zone strategy. Zone 1, the downtown core, would consist of structured parking at high daily rates with a maximum stay limit; existing surface lots would be progressively redeveloped. Zone 2, at BRT corridor stops, would consist of structured garages at moderate daily rates with bundled transit day passes. Zone 3, at the BRT terminus adjacent to the Vision Lands, would consist of free or near-free surface parking to absorb commuter demand. Total parking supply would remain approximately constant; the distribution of supply across the corridor would change.

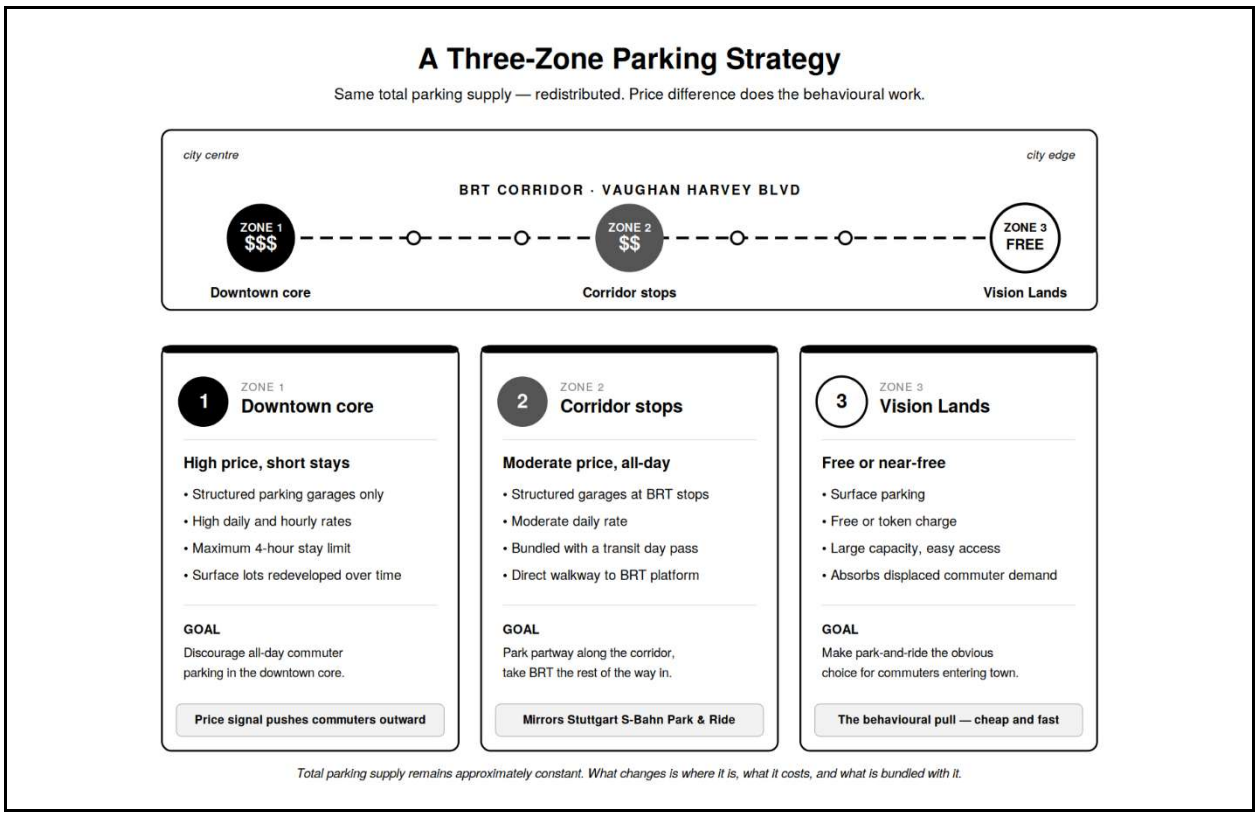



*Figure 12: Three-zone parking strategy — high price downtown, moderate at corridor stops, free at the Vision Lands terminus (Generated using AI-based diagramming tools)*

## 5.4 Financing: Tax Increment Financing gap and alternative mechanism

Financing presents the most significant adaptation challenge. Tax Increment Financing legislation exists in Manitoba (Community Revitalization and Tax Increment Financing Act, 2009) and in Ontario, with limited application elsewhere in Canada (Hopper, 2014; Province of Manitoba, 2009). New Brunswick has not enacted TIF legislation. This represents a substantive legislative gap. Without TIF, Moncton cannot formally issue bonds against future tax increment from a designated development zone.

An alternative mechanism is available within the existing legislative framework. The City of Moncton holds title to a number of downtown parking lots. Direct sale of these lots to developers, with proceeds directed to a dedicated transit infrastructure reserve fund, could finance BRT capital costs without TIF legislation. The fund would pay for capital expenditures as they are incurred. The Avenir Centre, constructed on former CN rail land in downtown Moncton, demonstrates that this type of redevelopment is feasible within New Brunswick's existing regulatory framework.

Sequencing is critical. If the city sells parking lots prior to the public announcement of the BRT project, developers capture the future value uplift attributable to transit. If lots are sold after BRT operations have commenced and surrounding land values have risen, the city captures a larger share of the value increase. The Stuttgart approach — announcement of the project, freeing of the land, then sale — produces a more favourable revenue outcome and should be adopted for Moncton.

# 6. Discussion and Conclusions

## 6.1 Model transferability with appropriate adaptation

The Stuttgart approach is transferable to Moncton when scaled appropriately. The structural elements are equivalent in both jurisdictions: locked central land, planned peripheral growth, transit infrastructure connecting the two, and a financing mechanism that recovers a portion of the land value created by the transit investment. The Moncton adaptation substitutes BRT for underground rail, surface parking redevelopment for underground station construction, and direct municipal land sales for formal TIF instruments. The underlying logic of transit-led land value capture remains intact.

## 6.2 Alignment with existing Moncton planning policy

A significant finding of this analysis is that the proposed adaptation does not conflict with any existing Moncton planning documents. Destination 2040 (HDR, 2015) explicitly called for densification and transit-oriented development along key corridors. The Urban Growth Strategy (City of Moncton, 2024) identifies infrastructure cost as the principal barrier to Vision Lands development. The Codiac Growth Strategy (Codiac Transpo, 2026) proposes transit signal priority enhancements but does not extend to full BRT. The Stuttgart-derived approach addresses the financing gap that these three documents collectively leave open.

## 6.3 Uncertainties and prerequisite work

Six unresolved issues require resolution before the proposed approach could advance to formal planning:

- Absence of Tax Increment Financing legislation in New Brunswick, and the legal sufficiency of the alternative direct-sale mechanism.
- Vaughan Harvey Boulevard Road geometry — requires a formal cross-section survey to confirm lane reallocation feasibility.
- Soil contamination conditions beneath downtown parking lots, which may materially reduce achievable land sale proceeds.
- Ownership inventory for downtown parking lots — a clear distinction between city-owned and privately-owned parcels is required.
- Underground utility locations along the proposed corridor.
- Political sustainability across a 20- to 25-year implementation horizon. The 2025 reversal of the St. George Boulevard cycle lane (CBC News, 2025) indicates that municipal infrastructure decisions in Moncton can be reversed under political pressure.

## 6.4 Conclusions

Stuttgart 21 is too large in absolute scale to copy directly. The underlying mechanism — applying transit investment to unlock land and using captured land value to contribute to transit financing — is scale-independent. A reduced-scale adaptation centred on a Vaughan Harvey BRT corridor connecting the downtown core to the Vision Lands could implement the same mechanism in Moncton.

The mechanism is technically sound. The principal open question is whether Moncton's municipal and regional institutions are positioned to plan over a 20-year horizon, sequence implementation steps appropriately, and maintain political commitment through electoral cycles. This represents the more substantial challenge.

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